BillBoard — Marquee & Advertisement Guide

How to control the scrolling notice and the bottom banner after the app is published — without ever shipping a new APK. Version 1.0.2 · 20 August 2026

> **Both features are OFF in this release.** The app looks and behaves exactly as before. Nothing appears until you publish a `config.json` that turns them on, which you can do at any time.

1. How it works

On every launch (and whenever you press the refresh button), BillBoard quietly downloads one small JSON file from your GitHub Pages site. That file decides whether the notice and the banner are shown, what they say, what image they use, and where they link to. The app never blocks on this download — if it fails, BillBoard carries on exactly as normal.

```
App starts  →  shows meters immediately
            →  downloads config.json in the background
            →  valid?  yes → save a copy + apply it
                       no  → keep using the last saved copy
                             (nothing saved yet → both features stay hidden)
```

2. One-time setup (about 5 minutes)

The config must be served over **HTTPS from a public location**. The app deliberately refuses plain `http://` links. GitHub Pages is free and works well.

1. Create a **public** GitHub repository named `BillBoard`.
2. Add a file named `config.json` at the top level (contents in section 3).
3. Create a folder named `ads` and upload your banner images there.
4. Go to **Settings** → **Pages**. Under “Build and deployment”, set *Source* = **Deploy from a branch**, *Branch* = **main**, folder = **/ (root)**. Save.
5. Wait 1–2 minutes, then open `https://akifislam.github.io/BillBoard/config.json` in a browser. If you see the JSON, you are done.

> **The repository must be public.** A private repo's Pages site requires a login, which the app cannot (and must not) provide. There are no tokens or passwords inside the APK, by design.

Final repository layout

```
BillBoard/
├── config.json
└── ads/
    ├── tutor_connect.webp
    ├── admission.webp
    └── campaign_03.webp
```

Where the URL lives in the app

The app reads exactly one address, defined in a single place:

```
app/src/main/java/com/butterflydevs/billboard/data/remote/RemoteConfigRepository.kt

object RemoteConfigUrls {
    const val PRODUCTION_CONFIG_URL =
        "https://akifislam.github.io/BillBoard/config.json"
}
```

Only change this if your GitHub username changes — replace the bold part. Everything else (text, images, links, scheduling, on/off) is controlled from `config.json`, with no rebuild.

3. The config file

This is the complete file. Copy it as-is to start.

```
{
  "marquee": {
    "enabled": false,
    "text": "আপনার অভিযোগ টিউশন এখানে যোগ করে আয় করুন",
    "click_url": ""
  },

  "advertisement": {
    "enabled": false,
    "id": "tutor_connect_001",
    "image_url": "https://akifislam.github.io/BillBoard/ads/tutor_connect.webp",
    "click_url": "https://example.com/tutor-connect",
    "start_date": "",
    "end_date": ""
  }
}
```

Field	What it does
marquee.enabled	`true` shows the scrolling notice, `false` hides it completely (no empty gap).
marquee.text	The notice text. Bengali and English both work. Long text scrolls; short text sits still.
marquee.click_url	Optional. If set, tapping the notice opens it. Leave `""` to make it non-clickable.
advertisement.enabled	`true` shows the bottom banner, `false` hides it and gives the space back to the meter list.
advertisement.id	Your own label for the campaign. The app doesn't act on it; it's for your bookkeeping.
advertisement.image_url	HTTPS link to the banner image.
advertisement.click_url	Where tapping the banner goes.
advertisement.start_date	Optional. The banner stays hidden until this moment.
advertisement.end_date	Optional. The banner disappears after this moment.

4. Everyday tasks

Turn the marquee ON or OFF

Edit `config.json`, set `"enabled"` inside the `"marquee"` block:

```
"marquee": { "enabled": true,  ... }   ← notice appears
"marquee": { "enabled": false, ... }   ← notice disappears entirely
```

Commit the change. Users see it on their next app open, or immediately if they tap the refresh button.

Turn the advertisement ON or OFF

```
"advertisement": { "enabled": true,  ... }   ← banner appears
"advertisement": { "enabled": false, ... }   ← banner disappears
```

The two switches are completely independent — you can run the notice with no ad, or an ad with no notice.

Change the marquee text

Edit the `"text"` value. Nothing else needs to change.

Change the banner image

1. Upload the new image into the `ads/` folder, using a **new filename**.
2. Point `"image_url"` at the new filename.

> Always use a new filename rather than overwriting the old one. Images are cached on the device for speed, so reusing a filename can leave some users looking at the old picture for a while. A new name guarantees everyone gets the new banner.

Change where the banner links to

Edit `"click_url"`. It must start with `https://` — an `http://` link is ignored and the banner simply becomes non-clickable.

Schedule a campaign

Use ISO-8601 timestamps with the Bangladesh offset `+06:00`:

```
"start_date": "2026-09-01T00:00:00+06:00",
"end_date":   "2026-09-30T23:59:59+06:00"
```

The banner shows only inside that window. Outside it — even with `"enabled": true` — it stays hidden, and it disappears on its own the moment the end date passes, with no action from you.

- Leave `start_date` empty to start immediately.
- Leave `end_date` empty to run until you turn it off.
- A mistyped date hides the banner rather than showing it at the wrong time.

5. Banner image size

Recommended size	**1200 × 300 pixels** (4:1 ratio)
Also fine	1080 × 270, 1200 × 360 (3.3:1), anything from about 3:1 to 5:1
Format	WebP preferred (smallest), PNG or JPG also work
File size	Keep under about 150 KB; the app refuses anything over 4 MB
On-screen height	Capped at 96 dp, so the banner never crowds the meter cards

The image is scaled to the screen width with its proportions preserved — it is never stretched or squashed. A 4:1 image fills the width exactly at the height cap, which is why it is the recommended shape. Taller images are shrunk to fit the cap and will sit narrower than full width.

Keep important text away from the extreme left and right edges, since the banner is inset slightly from the screen edges.

6. Testing before you publish

1. Edit `config.json` and commit it.
2. Open `https://akifislam.github.io/BillBoard/config.json` in a browser and confirm you see the change. GitHub can take a minute or two.
3. Open BillBoard and tap the **refresh** button in the toolbar. It fetches the config immediately, so you see the result right away rather than waiting for the next launch.

To rehearse against a staging file without touching the live one, build a debug copy pointed elsewhere:

```
./gradlew installDebug -Pbillboard.configUrl=https://your-test-host/config.json
```

Release builds ignore that flag entirely and always use the production URL.

7. What happens when things go wrong

All of the following were tested on-device. In every case BillBoard keeps working normally.

Situation	What the user sees
No internet	Meters show their last saved balances with an “offline” notice; the last saved marquee and banner still appear.
GitHub is down or unreachable	The last good config keeps being used.
You publish broken JSON	It is ignored; the last good config keeps being used. Nothing breaks.
The banner image URL is wrong or dead	The banner is hidden entirely. No broken-image icon, no empty gap.
The campaign end date has passed	The banner disappears by itself, even offline.
First install with no connection	Neither feature appears; the app still runs.
A link is not `https://`	The link is ignored and that element simply is not tappable.

8. Safety notes

- Only `https://` links are ever accepted, loaded, or opened.
- The banner is drawn as a plain image — no WebView, so nothing in your config can run HTML or JavaScript.
- The config can change text, images, links and visibility. It cannot make the app do anything else.
- No GitHub token, password, or secret is stored in the app. Publishing is done by you, on GitHub.
- Unrecognised fields in the JSON are ignored, so you can add new settings later without breaking versions already installed on people's phones.

> **Quick reference**
> Turn notice on/off → `marquee.enabled` · Change its words → `marquee.text`
> Turn ad on/off → `advertisement.enabled` · New picture → upload to `ads/`, update `image_url`
> New destination → `advertisement.click_url` · Schedule → `start_date` / `end_date`
> Banner size → **1200 × 300 px**, WebP, under 150 KB